

Minimum Viable Narrative

INSTRUCTIONS

GOAL

Turn your test hypothesis into a narrative your no-code/low-code tool can build from.

1 - Carry In Your Hypothesis

Copy your prototype hypothesis from the previous lesson into the top field. This is the bet you are building toward. Don't rewrite it.

2 - Name Your Target Audience

One sentence. Who is this person, where are they, and what are they in the middle of trying to do? Not a persona card. A character in a moment of the narrative.

3 - Write the Five Narrative Beats

Map the narrative your prototype needs to tell. Remember, your target audience is the main character and hero of the story.

- **Setup** — who they are and what they need
- **Encounter** — what the system shows them
- **Action** — what they do or give the system
- **Response** — what the system does with it
- **Resolution** — what success looks and feels like

Keep each narrative beat to one or two sentences. You are writing a story, not a spec.

4 - Assemble the Prompt

Combine your hypothesis, audience, and five narrative beats into the Productside provided prompt. Paste the result into the No/Lo-Code Prompt field. Then feed it to your tool.

5 - Build the Prototype

Using the no/lo-code tool of your choosing, past in the prompt you generated.

6 - Run the Prototype

See if you can have someone on your team run your prototype

Prototype Hypothesis

[Copy your statement from the previous lesson]

Type your paragraph...

Target Audience

[Tells us about who is going to view or use your prototype]

Type your paragraph...

Setup

[Who is this person, where are they, and what do they need?]

Type your paragraph...

Encounter

[What do they see when they arrive? What is the system showing them?]

Type your paragraph...

Action - Response Loop

Action

[What do they do? What choice or input do they give?]

Type your paragraph...

Response

[What does the system do with input, what comes back?]

Type your paragraph...

Resolution

[How does it end? What does success look and feel like?]

Type your paragraph...

No/Lo-Code Prompt

[copy and paste the prompt you generated based on your hypothesis, audience, narrative]

Type your paragraph...

VIBE PROTOTYPING - PROMPT

Productside Vibe Prototype Metaprompt

You are going to help me write a prompt for a no/lo-code AI builder like Lovable, Base44, or v0.

The prompt you generate should direct the tool to build a functional, throwaway prototype — realistic enough to provoke an honest reaction from a user, not polished enough to ship.

The prototype exists to validate or invalidate this hypothesis from the perspective of the prospective end-user:

Hypothesis
[paste hypothesis]

Audience
[paste audience sentence]

The Story
The prototype needs to move a user through these five moments:

- **Setup:** [paste beat]
- **Encounter:** [paste beat]
- **Action:** [paste beat]
- **Response:** [paste beat]
- **Resolution:** [paste beat]

Your Output
Write a prompt I can paste directly into Lovable, Base44, or v0 that:

- Builds only the functionality this story requires
- Looks and feels like a working product.
- Leaves out anything not in the story above
- Produces something a user can react to without anyone explaining it to them

- **IMPORTANT! BE DESCRIPTIVE, NOT PRESCRIPTIVE.** The idea is to allow the coding agent to determine the best design.